

Monday, 3 August 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 32° 19°	BIRMINGHAM Light drizzle 32° 16°	MANCHESTER Drizzle 29° 18°	GLASGOW Drizzle 20° 14°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

The head of the National Farmers' Union is warning that a prolonged drought could lead to shortages of some of our favourite foods.

NFU president Tom Bradshaw is urging the government to act now to protect the UK's food supply from extreme weather. It's a worrying prospect for our supermarket shelves.

FOOD · UK
- 2

Three people have been hospitalised after a fire and crush at the Ghana Party in the Park festival in London.

Organisers described the day as 'difficult' and 'deeply upsetting' following the incidents. Emergency services were called to the event.

INCIDENT · UK
- 3

Police in Cumbria are investigating after a 17-year-old girl tragically died following a 'medical episode' at the Kendal Calling festival.

The teenager was attending the popular music festival when the incident occurred. Our thoughts are with her family and friends.

INCIDENT · UK
- 4

The ballot paper for the upcoming Clacton by-election is making history, becoming the longest in British electoral history.

Voters will face a list of 34 candidates, with the paper itself reportedly stretching to nearly a metre long. It certainly gives voters plenty to consider!

POLITICS · UK
- 5

A takeaway owner in Falkirk was subjected to racist abuse before being violently attacked by a gang of men.

Police are treating the incident, which happened last month, as a hate crime. It's a shocking and unacceptable act of violence.

CRIME · UK

What's coming up

1 Spider-Man fans are absolutely raving about Tom Holland's latest web-slinging adventure, hailing 'Brand New Day' as his best performance yet.

The new film is clearly a huge hit with audiences, who are full of praise for the British actor. Sounds like a must-see for superhero fans!

ON AIR – Are you a fan of the Spider-Man films? Which one is your favourite?

FILM · COMING UP

2 Sam Fender and Olivia Dean have made chart history, with their duet 'Rein Me In' breaking a 73-year-old record.

The track has now spent an incredible 19 non-consecutive weeks at the top of the UK singles chart. What an achievement for both artists!

ON AIR – Have you heard 'Rein Me In'? What do you think of it?

MUSIC · NOW

3 Zendaya and Tom Holland's real-life romance is celebrating a decade, with a look back at their Spider-Man journey in pictures.

The couple, who recently tied the knot, met on the set of the superhero franchise ten years ago. It's a lovely look back at their journey together.

ON AIR – Do you think on-screen chemistry often leads to off-screen romance?

CELEBRITY · NOW

4 For one Somerset man, playing a Spider-Man double was a 'childhood dream' come true.

Teifion Sussex got to step into the iconic suit and embody the friendly neighbourhood superhero. What an exciting experience!

ON AIR – What was your childhood dream job?

FILM · NOW

5 Big news from the gaming world, as Xbox workers are said to be 'stunned' after a 'bloodbath' of job cuts.

Microsoft, who owns the video game giant, plans to let go of 3,200 workers. It's a huge shake-up for the industry.

ON AIR – Are you a keen gamer? How do you think this will impact the industry?

GAMING · NOW

On the schedule

1 **After a bruising 24 hours, pressure is mounting on Fifa president Gianni Infantino following the implosion of a controversial World Cup investment plan.**

Questions are now being asked about whether Infantino can survive as the head of football's governing body. It's a huge story in the world of football.

ON AIR – Do you think Gianni Infantino will be able to weather this storm?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **England's netball coach is set to 'reassess' her future after the team missed out on a medal at the Commonwealth Games.**

The Roses were outclassed by Australia, losing 68-50 in their quest for bronze. A disappointing end for the team.

ON AIR – What do you think is next for England netball?

NETBALL · UK

3 **Bournemouth are reportedly close to signing Sevilla right-back Juanlu in an £11.1 million deal.**

New manager Marco Rose is quickly building his squad as the Premier League season approaches. It's an exciting time for Cherries fans!

ON AIR – Which new signings are you most excited about this season?

FOOTBALL · UK

4 **Jofra Archer delivered an 'awesome' four-wicket spell as Southern Brave bowled out London Spirit for just 105 in The Hundred.**

Archer took four wickets for only nine runs at Lord's, a brilliant performance. It was a dominant display from the Brave.

ON AIR – Are you enjoying The Hundred this year? Which team are you backing?

CRICKET · UK

5 **Joe Root starred with an unbeaten 58 as Welsh Fire beat Birmingham Phoenix by seven wickets in The Hundred at Edgbaston.**

Root's impressive knock from 40 balls guided the Fire to a convincing win. He's certainly in fine form!

ON AIR – What's been your favourite moment from The Hundred so far?

CRICKET · UK

Quick hits

1 Scientists are exploring the fascinating world of 'plant intelligence' and how flora might communicate with each other.

New research suggests that plants use complex chemical signals and even underground fungal networks to 'talk' and share resources, revealing a hidden world of botanical socialising.

2 The humble 'picnic blanket' is getting a stylish upgrade, with more people investing in chic and durable outdoor throws.

From waterproof bases to roll-up designs with leather straps, the art of al fresco dining is becoming even more aesthetically pleasing for park and beach outings.

3 Experts are highlighting the calming effect of 'observing fish in aquariums' as a form of stress relief.

Studies indicate that watching aquatic life can lower blood pressure and heart rate, offering a peaceful escape from daily pressures, even if it's just a screen saver.

4 The trend of 'repurposing old luggage' into unique home decor items is gaining popularity.

Vintage suitcases are being transformed into side tables, pet beds, and even bathroom storage, adding a touch of nostalgic charm to interiors.

5 There's a growing movement to 'rekindle the art of letter writing' to maintain connections with loved ones.

Advocates suggest that the personal touch of a handwritten note offers a deeper, more meaningful connection than instant digital messages, fostering a sense of anticipation and joy.

6 The simple joy of 'making friendship bracelets' is making a delightful comeback among adults.

What was once a childhood pastime is now seen as a mindful, creative activity and a thoughtful way to show appreciation for friends and family.

7 A new appreciation for 'historic village signs' is emerging across the UK.

Many communities are undertaking projects to restore or research their unique signs, which often depict local history, industry, or folklore, preserving cultural heritage.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what with our socks before putting them on?

ANSWER: GIVING THEM A LITTLE STRETCH, JUST TO MAKE SURE THEY'RE COMFY!

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before enjoying a lovely, fresh cup of tea. What is it?

ANSWER: GIVING THE MUG A LITTLE SWIRL, EVEN AFTER IT'S BEEN STIRRED, JUST FOR GOOD MEASURE!

TALK TOPIC

- **We all have those 'unusual item combinations' that we absolutely love, even if others find them a bit peculiar!**

Is there a food pairing you adore that might raise an eyebrow, or maybe a strange but effective way you use two seemingly unrelated objects together? Give us a call!

- **Think about a 'small act of kindness' you've either given or received recently that really brightened your day.**

Was it a thoughtful gesture from a stranger, a kind word from a friend, or perhaps something you did for someone else that brought a smile? We'd love to hear your stories!

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Space.** The footprints left by astronauts on the Moon could remain there for millions of years because there is no wind or water to erode them.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Astronauts on the International Space Station can only shower once a month due to water rationing.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£6.8 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£6.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The 'Great Fire of London' in 1666 actually helped to eradicate the Black Death in the city by destroying the rat-infested homes.
- A 'group of rhinos' is called a crash.
- The 'colour orange' was named after the fruit, not the other way around.
- Flamingos get their pink colour from the beta-carotene in the brine shrimp and algae they eat.
- The 'shortest war in history' was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896, lasting only 38 minutes.
- The 'Eiffel Tower' can be 15 cm taller during the summer due to the thermal expansion of the iron.
- Octopuses have 'three hearts'; two pump blood through the gills, and one circulates it to the rest of the body.
- The 'crisp packet' was invented in the UK in 1948 by Frank Smith and his wife, starting with plain crisps and a salt sachet.

On this day

Day 215 of the year, 150 days left in 2026. Today Anniversary of the Killing of Pidjiguiti (Guinea-Bissau); Armed Forces Day (Equatorial Guinea); Christian feast day: Blessed Augustin Kažotić; Christian feast day: George Freeman Bragg, W. E. B. Du Bois (Episcopal Church). Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1963 — Lisa Ann Walter, American actress, producer, and screenwriter
- 1954 — Gary Peters, English footballer and manager
- 1950 — John Landis, American actor, director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1993 — Ola Abidogun, English sprinter
- 1963 — James Hetfield, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1930 — James Komack, American actor, director, producer, and screenwriter (died 1997)
- 1956 — Dave Cloud, American singer-songwriter and actor (died 2015)
- 1980 — Nadia Ali, Libyan-American singer-songwriter

THE DAY TODAY

- 1981 — Senegalese opposition parties, under the leadership of Mamadou Dia, launch the Antiimperialist Action Front – Suxxali Reew Mi.
- 2014 — A 6.1 magnitude earthquake kills at least 617 people and injures more than 2,400 in Yunnan, China.
- 1936 — Jesse Owens wins the 100 metre dash, defeating Ralph Metcalfe, at the Berlin Olympics.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1981 — Senegalese opposition parties, under the leadership of Mamadou Dia, launch the Antiimperialist Action Front – Suxxali Reew Mi.
- 1949 — The Basketball Association of America and the National Basketball League finalize the merger that would create the National Basketball Association.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2007 — Former deputy director of the Chilean secret police Raúl Iturriaga is captured after having been on the run following a conviction for kidnapping.
- 1940 — World War II: Italian forces begin the invasion of British Somaliland.

- 2014 — A 6.1 magnitude earthquake kills at least 617 people and injures more than 2,400 in Yunnan, China.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 216 of the year, 149 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Aristarchus; Christian feast day: Blessed Cecilia Cesarini; Christian feast day: Euphronius; Christian feast day: Blessed Frédéric Janssoone. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1954 — Steve Phillips, English footballer
- 1985 — Crystal Bowersox, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1998 — Lil Skies, American rapper
- 1970 — John August, American director and screenwriter
- 1983 — Greta Gerwig, American actress, producer, and screenwriter
- 1962 — Paul Reynolds, English singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1994 — Bobby Shmurda, American rapper
- 1941 — Cliff Nobles, American musician (died 2008)

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1983 — Jean-Baptiste Ouédraogo, president of the military government of Upper Volta, is ousted from power in a coup d'état led by Captain Thomas Sankara.
- 1924 — Diplomatic relations between Mexico and the Soviet Union are established.
- 1964 — Civil rights movement: Civil rights workers Michael Schwerner, Andrew Goodman and James Chaney are found dead in Mississippi after disappearing on June 21.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2018 — Crisis in Venezuela: Seven people are injured when two drones detonate explosives on Avenida Bolívar, Caracas while president Nicolás Maduro is giving a speech to the Venezuelan National Guard.
- 2019 — Nine people are killed and 26 injured in a shooting in Dayton, Ohio. This comes only 13 hours after another mass shooting in El Paso, Texas, where 23 people were killed.

Coming to cinemas

AUGUST 2026

FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

AUGUST 2026

W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)